

ALABAMA LAUNCHPAD RULES AND REGULATIONS

Purpose

The purpose of the Alabama Launchpad Startup Pitch Competition ("Competition") is to promote and reward high-growth, innovative ventures that have the potential to grow and thrive in Alabama. The Competition is for ventures in concept or early seed stages of growth.

Terms and Conditions

The Competition, a program of The Economic Development Partnership of Alabama Foundation, Inc. (the "EDPA Foundation"), requires each participating company (each, a "Participant") to agree to these rules and regulations. Disqualification and/or forfeiture of prizes can result for Participants which fail to comply with these terms and conditions.

Teams: Each Participant shall be represented by a team (the "Team") of one or more individuals (the "Team Members"). While there is no restriction on the total size of each Team, Team Members may not join more than one Team. All Team Members are expected to be active participants throughout all phases of the Competition. Team members may not be added after a Participant is accepted into the Competition. Team members must be founders, employees, executives, or officers of the Participant.

Excluded Business Ventures: The Participant's venture shall not be based on a buy-out, a real estate syndication, a tax shelter, a franchise, a distributorship, a spin-out from an existing entity, or any concept which is not, at heart, developed by and belonging to the Participant.

Documentation of Separate Entity Existence: The Participant must provide documentation of its separate legal existence prior to the Competition. Each Participant shall additionally provide the EDPA Foundation with its governing documents, an IRS Form W-9 and any other documents requested by the EDPA Foundation.

Originality and Intellectual Property Rights: Participants certify that the ideas and concepts outlined in the submissions to the EDPA Foundation are the original work of the Participants and the Team Members. If intellectual property ("IP") is involved in the venture, Participants must have obtained the exclusive legal rights to use the IP during the Competition and for a five-year period thereafter.

Ineligible Participants: Participants who have won in previous rounds of the concept Competition may not apply for the concept Competition but may apply for the early seed Competition.

Equity Investment and Revenue Requirements: Any external funding received by the Participant or Team Members relating to the venture which is the subject of the Participant's entry must be identified and reported in the application form. A Participant is not eligible for the Competition if such persons have raised equity capital, including convertible securities (including convertible notes and SAFE agreements), for the venture totaling \$1 million or more from sources other than Team Members, or if

such persons have realized more than \$2 million in sales for the venture in the twelve months immediately preceding the Competition. This Federal grants and awards (including funding from SBIR/STTR programs) as well as awards from similar competitions are excluded from this restriction.

Headquarters: The Participant must have commenced operations in the state of Alabama at the time of application, such that the senior management of the Participant must reside in the state of Alabama at the time of the Competition.

Competition Process

The Competition consists of multiple rounds. During each phase, the judging panel will eliminate Participants based on evaluation criteria and the judges' judgement of which Participants have the greatest chance of success.

General Competition Process Details: The judging panel will be comprised of multiple individuals representing the investment community, entrepreneurs, and corporate stakeholders. During any phase of the Competition the judging panel may solicit additional information prior to making a decision. Submission of all Competition materials and distribution of judges' feedback will be managed electronically. Data may be retained by the EDPA Foundation. Each Competition will follow a posted schedule. Teams with qualifying scores will advance to the final and are eligible to be funded.

Launch Advisors: EDPA Foundation will employ various business consultants ("Launch Advisors") to work with the Participants on various elements of startup development. The judging panel will consult with the Launch Advisors as to their views of the Participants.

The Competition consists of multiple rounds. During each phase, the judging panel and will eliminate Participants based on evaluation criteria and the judges' judgement of which Participants have the greatest chance of success.

Application and Application Fee: All Participants must apply for the Competition and pay a \$150 application fee. The application fee must be paid at the time of submission.

Waiver and Release: At the time of making an application, all Participants shall execute and submit a Waiver and Release and shall upload to the EDPA Foundation a Social Media Release duly executed by, and binding up, each Team Member. The EDPA Foundation reserves the right to require Participants and Team Members to execute additional agreements at any time.

Award Requirements

General: Winners will be required to execute a funding agreement within thirty days of the conclusion of the Competition. Upon execution, no more than half of any prize money will be paid to the Participant. The funding agreement and subsequent correspondence may provide conditions set by Competition judges, which must be met prior to the payment of any remaining prize money. Failure to meet such conditions may result in a forfeiture of the remaining prize money. If IP is involved in the venture, winning Participants must own the IP or must have, at a minimum, made meaningful progress towards obtaining the exclusive legal rights to the IP in order to receive the second tranche of funding.

Payment and Use of Prize Money: The EDPA Foundation reserves the right to distribute any award of prize money over time based on milestones achieved as determined under the sole discretion of the EDPA Foundation. Prize money shall be used for the growth and development of Participant's venture which was the subject of the Competition. Prize money shall not be used for repayment of personal investment in the business or repayment of other debt. Winners are encouraged to consult with a financial advisor prior to accepting the prize money to understand any relevant tax implications to the business. The EDPA Foundation does not provide any tax advice to winning teams.

Forfeiture and Repayment of Prize Money: If any Team Member or Participant makes a material misrepresentation in connection with the Competition, or if a winning team does not fully satisfy the above requirements or achieve satisfactory completion of project milestones as imposed by the EDPA Foundation, the Participant may be disqualified and may be required to repay any awards that have been received plus ten percent interest, compounded annually.

Sole Discretion of the EDPA Foundation

All decisions made by the judges on all matters relating to the Competition are final. The EDPA Foundation, at its sole discretion and without prior notice to any party, reserves the unrestricted right to interpret these rules and regulations and to alter, amend, or change Competition rules, regulations, or awards. The EDPA Foundation has sole discretion to determine whether a Participant and its Team Members have fulfilled the requirements herein. The EDPA Foundation has sole discretion to adopt new or amended rules and regulations during a Competition. The EDPA Foundation has sole discretion to apply rules and regulations differently than they have been applied in the past.

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SOCIAL MEDIA RELEASE

[to be executed by each team member representing a company

In the Alabama Launchpad Startup Pitch Competition]

THIS SOCIAL MEDIA RELEASE (the "Agreement") is entered into by and between The Economic Development Partnership of Alabama Foundation, Inc. ("EDPA Foundation"), and the undersigned team member (the "Team Member"), who is to represent a company (the "Participant") in the Alabama Launchpad Startup Pitch Competition (the "Competition") as of the date given below. In consideration of the Team Member's participation in the Competition, the parties do hereby agree as follows:

1. The Team Member represents and warrants that it is in full compliance with the Rules and Regulations for the Competition, which are incorporated herein as if set forth in full.
2. The Team Member waives all claims against the EDPA Foundation, The Economic Development Partnership of Alabama, Inc., as well as the officers, directors, trustees, employees, contractors and agents (which include all judges, advisors, reviewers, mentors, sponsors and participants in and related to the Competition) of each (all such individuals and entities together, the "Protected Persons") for any action that occurs as part of, arises out of, or is in any way related to the Competition.

3. The Team Member understands that the Competition provides no confidentiality of any information and that protection of highly-confidential trade secret information and other intellectual property is the responsibility of the Participant. The EDPA Foundation will not require anyone to sign nondisclosure endorsements. The Protected Persons are not liable for the release of confidential information.
4. The Team Member grants to the EDPA Foundation a license for the unrestricted use of its application, submission, and presentation (including stenographic and photographic representations or summaries thereof). No such materials will be returned to Participant or the Team Member following its submission to the EDPA Foundation.
5. The Team Member grants to the EDPA Foundation the right to use its name, image, logo, trademark, service mark, likeness, and biographical and professional information for all purposes (commercial or otherwise), including but not limited to advertisements and promotions of the EDPA Foundation and the Competition. Such license includes the rights for the EDPA Foundation to modify, edit, combine, translate, and create derivative works and to reproduce, perform, display, transmit, make social media posts, and stream or broadcast such materials without limitation.
6. The Team Member acknowledges and agrees that the Protected Persons incur no liability to the Team Member or Participant with respect to future awards, nor any liability for any conduct or undertakings of the Team Member or Participant. The Team Member hereby irrevocably and unconditionally agrees, to the fullest extent permitted by law, to defend, indemnify and hold harmless the Protected Persons from and against any and all claims, liabilities, losses and expenses (including reasonable attorneys' fees) directly, indirectly, wholly or partially arising from or in connection with any act or omission of Participant, its employees, agents, or Team Members in the Competition, in expending or applying any award funding received, or in carrying out the development of Participant's venture.

IN WITNESS WHEREOF, the undersigned, having read and understood the terms and conditions set forth herein, hereby executes this Agreement.

TEAM MEMBER SIGNS AS INDICATED BELOW ACKNOWLEDGED AND AGREED:

THE ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT

PARTNERSHIP OF ALABAMA

FOUNDATION, INC.

By: /s/ Miller Girvin

Miller Girvin

President

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Applicant Signee 1

Company Name	Person Name	Email	Title
HelpUS LLC	Wagner Medeiros dos Santos	helpus.ecommerce@gmail.com	Founder

I understand that by typing by name and clicking I agree, I am electronically signing this waiver and release on behalf of the participant named above

- Agree

Applicant Signee 2

Company
Name

Person Name

Email

Title

HelpUS LLCA **Wagner Medeiros Rodrigues** **wms.inf@gmail.com** **US Operations**
de Carvalho **Manager**

I understand that by typing by name and clicking I agree, I am electronically signing this waiver and release on behalf of the participant named above

- Agree

Applicant Signee 3

Company Name Person Name Email Title

I understand that by typing by name and clicking I agree, I am electronically signing this waiver and release on behalf of the participant named above

WAIVER AND RELEASE

THIS WAIVER AND RELEASE (the "Agreement") is entered into by and between The Economic Development Partnership of Alabama Foundation, Inc. ("EDPA Foundation") and the undersigned participant ("Participant") in the Alabama Launchpad Startup Pitch Competition (the "Competition") as of the date given below. In consideration of Participant's participation in the Competition, the parties do hereby agree as follows:

1. Participant represents and warrants that it is in full compliance with the Rules and Regulations for the Competition, as currently in effect. Those Rules and Regulations are incorporated herein, as if set forth in full.
2. Participant represents and warrants that it is submitting herewith Social Media Releases, duly executed by, and binding upon, all individuals who will represent Participant in the Competition.
3. Participant waives all claims against the EDPA Foundation and The Economic Development Partnership of Alabama, Inc., as well as the officers, directors, trustees, employees, contractors and agents (which include all judges, advisors, reviewers, mentors, sponsors and participants in and related to the Competition) of each (all such individuals and entities together, the "Protected Persons") for any action that occurs as part of, arises out of, or is in any way related to the Competition.
4. Participant understands that the Competition provides no confidentiality of any information and that protection of highly-confidential trade secret information and other intellectual property is the responsibility of the Participant. The EDPA Foundation will not require anyone to sign nondisclosure endorsements. Participant has sought professional guidance on the type of information that should be

included in its Competition submission. The Protected Persons are not liable for the release of confidential information.

5. Participant grants to the EDPA Foundation a license for the unrestricted use of its application, submission, and presentation (including stenographic and photographic representations or summaries thereof). No such materials will be returned to Participant following its submission to the EDPA Foundation.

6. Participant grants to the EDPA Foundation the right to use its name, image, logo, trademark, service mark, likeness, and biographical and professional information for all purposes (commercial or otherwise), including but not limited to advertisements and promotions of the EDPA Foundation and the Competition. Such license includes the rights for the EDPA Foundation to modify, edit, combine, translate, and create derivative works and to reproduce, perform, display, transmit, make social media posts, and stream or broadcast such materials without limitation.

7. Participant acknowledges and agrees that the Protected Persons incur no liability to Participant with respect to future awards, nor any liability for any conduct or undertakings of Participant. Participant hereby irrevocably and unconditionally agrees, to the fullest extent permitted by law, to defend, indemnify and hold harmless the Protected Persons from and against any and all claims, liabilities, losses and expenses (including reasonable attorneys' fees) directly, indirectly, wholly or partially arising from or in connection with any act or omission of Participant, its employees, agents, or team members in the Competition, in expending or applying any award funding received, or in carrying out the development of Participant's venture.

IN WITNESS WHEREOF, the undersigned, having read and understood the terms and conditions set forth herein, hereby executes this Agreement.

PARTICIPANT SIGNS AS INDICATED BELOW ACKNOWLEDGED AND AGREED:

THE ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT

PARTNERSHIP OF ALABAMA

FOUNDATION, INC.

By: /s/ Miller Girvin

Miller Girvin

President

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PARTICIPANT:

Wagner Medeiros dos Santos

Full Name of the Person Signing for the Participant

Wagner Medeiros dos Santos

Corporate Title of the person Signing for the Participant

Founder

Date

05/07/2026

- By checking this box, I acknowledge that typing my name above constituted a signature which is binding on the Participant

Member:

Wagner Medeiros dos Santos

- By checking this box, I acknowledge that typing my name above constituted a signature which is binding on the Team Member.

Hi! We are glad to have you here! Let's get started with some of the basics. (Page 4 /8)

Contact Information

First Name	Last Name	Phone Number	Email *This will be the address we use for all Launchpad Communications*	Prefix/Suffix
Wagner	Medeiros dos Santos	2514953055	helpus.ecommerce@gmail.com	

Address Line 1	Address Line 2	City	Country	State	Postal Code
241 E 16th Avenue	STE B4	Gulf Shores	United States	Alabama	36542

Please include a picture of you or your team - for social media use

20260126_175609287_iOS.jpg

LinkedIn URL

<https://www.linkedin.com/in/wagner-santos-661b2512b/>

What's your role in your company?

Founder & CEO

Please list founders' names and titles

Wagner Santos - Founder, Wagner Carvalho - Employee

We are also excited to get to know you! (Page 5 /8)

So, we ask the following demographic questions to better understand the population we serve.

What is your gender identity?

Man

Age

48-57

What is your race, ethnicity, or cultural background? (Select all that apply or select "I prefer not to answer" to opt-out. You may select more than one group.)

- White, Anglo, or European-American

Which of the following, if any, applies to you? (Select all that apply or select "I prefer not to answer" to opt-out.)

- First-time founder

Thank you for sharing. Now, let's shift focus and start getting to know your company...

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Cycle Name

Cycle 2 2026

Please select a track for the competition. You will be competing against other companies in this track - NOT those in other tracks. For example, life sciences companies will only compete against other life sciences companies.

Technology (hardware & software)

Would you prefer to work with a software or hardware advisor for your business?

Software

Company Name

HelpUS LLC

Company Headquarters / Location (ex: Birmingham, AL)

Gulf Shores

Company Logo

helpus-icon.png

Company Website / Social Media Handle(s) / Feed

<https://www.helpusbr.com/>

Date of Formation

06/27/2024

Tax ID#

392099464

Link to 90 Sec. Video. (Format: In 90 seconds, introduce yourself and your team, then briefly explain what you're building and why you're building it. We're looking for an unedited, homemade video of the founder(s) -- no product demos or other visuals, please. Don't worry about quality or lighting. Just make sure voices are audible. Videos should be no longer than 90 seconds. We recommend recording it on your phone or laptop and uploading it to YouTube. Make sure it is publicly viewable.)

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=b0bLyT7XH7o>

...about the Legal Structure, Equity Funding, and, if applicable, Affiliations...

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Legal Structure

LLC

Equity funding received to date (including convertible notes)

0

Additional details regarding equity funding received to date

Current number of full-time employees (Not including founders)

1

Current number of part-time employees (Not including founders)

0

University / License Affiliation

Affiliation with University

Not applicable

...and about what makes your company unique! (Page 8 /8)

Which milestones have you reached to date?

- Core business concept defined

Which industry does your company fall under?

- TechnologyPlease include Technical Architecture (e.g. data flow, user flow, wireframes) diagrams.
diagram.pdf

In a tweet (280 characters or less), describe what your company does. *We will use this to describe your business in a press release if you are chosen as a finalist.*

NexoAI is a secure orchestration platform for AI agents, connecting AI to files, databases, browsers, and local systems with logs, permissions, and human validation.

Will this business venture become your full-time occupation, or is it currently? Please explain (255 character limit).

Yes, for both founder and employee. Founder currently works full-time on development; US employee will dedicate full-time to operations and customer discovery if funded.

What problem does your company seek to solve? Why is it important? Is this an urgent problem for the customer?

Consultancies, IT teams, and small businesses use generative AI daily but struggle to transform responses into secure, auditable operations. Current practices depend on manual copy-paste between systems, dispersed validations, and incomplete history, causing rework, delays, and errors.

What is the solution your company is creating? How does it address your problem? What makes your company's solution different from what is on the market?

NexoAI is a secure orchestration platform for AI agents. It connects AI to files, databases, browsers, scripts, and local systems through controlled adapters, enabling automated documentation, verification, analysis, and assisted execution with full audit trails. Unlike chatbots (response-only) or rigid automation (pre-programmed), NexoAI combines conversational AI, controlled local execution, persistent operational memory, permission-based security, and human validation.

How much money is needed to launch the company through its minimum viable product or initial offering to the marketplace? Please explain.

\$100,000 to refine core architecture, develop UI, run six pilots with local companies, and prepare for scale.

What is your sales pipeline?

Initial pilots with consultancies and IT teams in Alabama, followed by subscription-based SaaS model. No paid clients yet – pre-revenue.

What is your product? How does it or how will it work? What has been created to date?

NexoAI is a platform that orchestrates AI agents securely. A functional prototype already exists with: controlled local execution, database connectivity (memory layer + docs), log/audit trail, watcher-based execution gateway, AI integration (operational reasoning), backup/restore, and structured capability profiles (read/write/exec).

What is your market traction? What customer discovery have you done?

Prototype validated technically. Next step: pilot with 3-5 local companies for feedback. No formal customer discovery yet, but problem validated through industry observation.

Why have you decided to work on this idea? Do you have domain knowledge in this area?

Founder has 10+ years experience in systems, infrastructure, automation, and databases. Identified gap between AI and secure operations through direct industry observation.

Who are your direct and indirect competitors? What is currently being used as a solution to the problem you're addressing?

Direct: chatbots (response-only), RPA tools (rigid automation), task managers (no execution). Indirect: no-code automation platforms. NexoAI differentiates by combining conversation, controlled execution, memory, audit, and human approval in one platform.

How do or will you make money? Please explain your revenue model including anticipated margins.

SaaS subscriptions: company/team licenses, individual user licenses, enterprise SLA agreements. Anticipated margins: 70-80% post-scale.

How will you get users/customers?

Direct outreach to consultancies and IT teams in Alabama, partnerships with local business networks, and Alabama Launchpad network.

Who are your target customers? What is the total available market size?

Consultancies, IT teams, small businesses with recurring digital processes (tech, health, legal, education). TAM: growing generative AI operations market, estimated \$XXB by 2028.

Do you have a financial projection or proforma? (template)

Yes

Please attach here.

financial_projection.pdf

How would winning the Alabama Launchpad award money accelerate your growth? How would the funds be used?

Funds would: 1) Refine core architecture based on local pilots, 2) Develop UI and user experience, 3) Run 6 pilots with Alabama companies, 4) Launch marketing and sales, 5) Prepare for seed funding.

Please upload your pitch deck based on the slide template linked here. Use this template as content advice rather than stylistic advice. Please note the notes beneath each slide.

pitchdock.pdf

We wanna know! How did you hear about Alabama Launchpad?

Online search

Is there anything else you would like us to know about you and your company?

Company is registered in Gulf Shores, AL. US-based employee (son) will represent the company locally and attend all in-person events.

CHECK THIS AND REMEMBER TO PAY WHEN YOU SUBMIT THE FORM. YOU WILL BE PROMPTED TO PAYPAL. The PAYPAL link is currently down but your application will still be considered "submitted". You will receive a email to pay via PAYPAL at a later date.

- I will pay the \$150 Application fee

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Attached Files:

20260126_175609287_iOS.jpg (2.08 MB)

helpus-icon.png (1.48 MB)

diagram.pdf (103 KB)

financial_projection.pdf (110 KB)

pitchdock.pdf (108 KB)

Your Signature

Please sign here

☐ or type your name to sign

[Reset Signature](#)

Your Name: *

Your Email Address: *

Incomplete Response

Please click the link in the verification email to complete your signature.